Johnny Chacón Gairaud

Sr. QA & Software Engineer | Senior SDET | Test Automation Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Automation-driven **Senior QA Engineer / SDET** with **7+ years** building and scaling **test automation** across web, desktop, API, and hardware platforms. Built and maintained **2,000+ automated tests** across multiple roles with Selenium, Playwright, Java, Python, and TypeScript, cutting regression time by **20%** through **CI/CD**-integrated quality gates in Jenkins and Azure DevOps. Drives **shift-left test strategy**, **API automation**, and AI-assisted test design (Codex) as a strong cross-functional collaborator in **Agile/Scrum** teams, applying a **Quality Engineering** mindset and comfortable owning problems independently. Fluent in English, remote-ready, with US time-zone overlap.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Scripting: C++, Java (incl. Java EE), Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Perl, SQL

Automation & Testing: Selenium (Python & Java), TestNG, JUnit, pytest, REST Assured, Playwright, Cypress, Cucumber (BDD/Gherkin), Postman, SoapUI, JMeter, Swagger/OpenAPI, Appium (academic exposure)

Frameworks & Design Patterns: Page Object Model (POM), MVC, Singleton

CI/CD & Build: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Gradle, TeamCity, Azure DevOps, Docker

Version Control: Git, Git Bash, GitHub, Azure Repos

Databases: MySQL, Oracle, PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL Server

Web Development: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Bootstrap, Materialize

Data Analysis: Python, Pandas, Jupyter

Operating Systems: Linux SUSE, Linux RHEL, Windows Server, Unix

Methodologies: Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Waterfall, Shift-Left Testing, Risk-Based Testing, BDD, TDD, Test Planning, STLC, SDLC

Project & Test Management: JIRA, Azure DevOps, Micro Focus ALM/Octane, TestLink, Rally, Jama Connect

AI-Assisted Testing: Codex, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude

Languages Spoken: English (Advanced/Fluent), Spanish (Native)

Core Strengths: Cross-functional communication, analytical troubleshooting, ownership & autonomy, adaptability, and fast ramp-up on new stacks

TESTING TYPES & METHODOLOGIES

API Testing, Automation Testing, Functional Testing, Regression Testing, Smoke Testing, Sanity Testing, Integration Testing, Unit Testing, End-to-End (E2E) Testing, Manual Testing, Exploratory Testing, Negative Testing, UI Testing, Database Testing, Accessibility Testing, Load Testing, Spike Testing, Stress Testing, Performance Testing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QAT Global | 2023 – 2026

QA Engineer

- Owned **test strategy** and execution across the full SDLC, supporting both Agile and Waterfall delivery models
- Proposed and rolled out **risk-based, shift-left, and API-first testing strategies** with developers and Product Owners, moving defect detection earlier in the cycle
- Built **REST API** validation coverage across 35+ endpoints in code with REST Assured — authentication/authorization testing (role-based access, token validation, session management) and request/response verification
- Hardened application reliability through systematic **negative testing** against edge cases and invalid inputs, uncovering 50+ defects before release
- Ran **containerized test suites with Docker on AWS** through TeamCity pipelines, keeping executions consistent across environments

- Validated web applications built on **React and Angular**, covering UI, business logic, and user workflows
- Led root-cause analysis with developers, Product Owners, BAs, and QA peers; worked directly with clients to scope requirements and expected behavior
- Used **AI tooling (Codex)** to speed up test-case generation, strategy design, and framework development, reducing test-case design time by 30%

Tools: Selenium, Playwright, REST Assured, Postman, SoapUI, JMeter, Docker, AWS, TeamCity, Jenkins, Gradle, Azure DevOps, Git, JIRA, SQL, React, Angular, Codex

Micro Focus (now OpenText) | 2020 – 2023

Software Automation Engineer

- Designed a **Java/TestNG/Selenium framework** (POM, data-driven, parallel execution on Selenium Grid) powering smoke, sanity, regression, and performance suites
- Added **API test coverage in code with REST Assured** alongside the UI suite, cutting reliance on manual checks
- Containerized the automation suite with **Docker** so Jenkins pipelines ran identical environments on every build
- Built reusable **test-data factories** and SQL seeding scripts for Oracle and PostgreSQL, removing stale-data failures across environments
- Scaled a **regression suite** with parallel execution in Jenkins, cutting runtime by 25% and **flaky failures by 30%**
- Complemented automation with **manual testing** and **exploratory testing** of enterprise web applications, triaging user-facing defects before release
- Supported release readiness as an embedded member of the **Scrum** team
- Mentored engineers across the organization on key **QA automation** areas — framework design, coding standards, test design, and CI/CD integration — lifting team velocity

Tools: RHEL, Linux SUSE, Jenkins, Docker, Java, Java EE, Selenium, Selenium Grid, REST Assured, Gradle, TestNG, Cypress, JavaScript, Oracle, PostgreSQL, HTML5, CSS3, Materialize, JIRA, Octane, Postman, Git, GitHub

HPE | 2019 – 2020

Testing and Automation Engineer

- Automated QA validation for ProLiant Gen10 server hardware, software, and configuration layers, and validated **30+ server configurations**
- Validated **firmware/BIOS configurations** on ProLiant Gen10 servers
- Led **automation innovation** across QA teams, introducing tooling and practices that replaced manual server validation workflows
- Gathered cross-team requirements to design scalable automation solutions
- Identified automation opportunities and closed coverage gaps across manual QA workflows
- Delivered **manual testing** and **exploratory testing** coverage for web applications
- Built functional, **integration testing**, and **performance testing** suites end-to-end

Tools: RHEL, Linux SUSE, Unix, Jenkins, Java, Python, C++, Selenium, Gradle, TestNG, Oracle, MySQL, Perl, Pandas, Jupyter, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, JIRA, TestLink, Scrum, Postman, Git, GitHub

EDUCATION

Universidad Nacional — Heredia, Costa Rica

Bachelor's Degree, Systems Engineering

SINAES-accredited program at the *Escuela de Informática* (Facultad de Ciencias Exactas y Naturales), focused on the analysis, design, and development of information systems for administrative, commercial, and technology-driven organizations. Curriculum spanning programming, database design & data modeling, computer networks, information security, software quality/testing, and IT project management.

ABOUT ME

I believe most problems have a solution if you're willing to look for it, even the tricky ones, or the ones where the obvious options are gone. New tools and unfamiliar tech don't rattle me; if anything, getting dropped into something I don't know yet is usually where I learn the most. Good code matters, but so does the team behind it. I think of a team like a machine: pour all your energy into just one part and the rest stalls out, but take care of every piece and it runs stronger,

together. That's the kind of environment I look for — one where I keep growing, keep getting challenged, and keep building things that actually work. Give me an internet connection, a laptop, and a problem worth solving, and I'll find a way through it.